

# Smoking Reference

Method and Rub Notes, kept by Charles Ferguson

These are my working notes for the smoker. Quantities are what I actually use, not what a label says. Adjust to your fire and your taste, but start here.

## All purpose beef rub

| Ingredient          | Amount        |
|---------------------|---------------|
| Coarse black pepper | 4 tablespoons |
| Kosher salt         | 3 tablespoons |
| Garlic powder       | 1 tablespoon  |
| Onion powder        | 1 tablespoon  |
| Smoked paprika      | 1 tablespoon  |

Mix and keep in a sealed jar on the rub shelf. This is the brisket and short rib rub. Heavy on pepper, light hand on everything else.

## Pork rub

| Ingredient     | Amount        |
|----------------|---------------|
| Brown sugar    | 4 tablespoons |
| Kosher salt    | 2 tablespoons |
| Paprika        | 2 tablespoons |
| Black pepper   | 1 tablespoon  |
| Chili powder   | 1 tablespoon  |
| Mustard powder | 1 teaspoon    |

Sweeter than the beef rub, for shoulder and ribs. The sugar helps the bark but watch the heat so it does not scorch.

## Temperatures and times

| Cut             | Smoker temp | Approx time    | Pull at        |
|-----------------|-------------|----------------|----------------|
| Brisket, packer | 225 F       | 12 to 14 hours | 203 F internal |
| Pork shoulder   | 250 F       | 10 to 12 hours | 203 F internal |
| Spare ribs      | 235 F       | 5 to 6 hours   | bend test      |
| Beef short ribs | 250 F       | 8 to 9 hours   | 203 F internal |

Times are a guide. Cook to temperature and feel, not the clock. Every brisket finishes when it finishes.

## **Wood and fire**

Post oak for beef, hickory for pork, apple for poultry, cherry for color and a milder smoke. Keep the fire clean and the smoke thin and blue. White billowing smoke means a dirty fire and bitter bark. Manage the vents, not the wood pile.

## **Rest and slice**

Rest a brisket at least an hour wrapped before slicing, longer if you can. Slice against the grain, and remember the grain changes direction between the flat and the point. A rushed rest undoes a good cook.

Charles Ferguson, kept on the kitchen shelf.